Comptia A+

TROUBLESHOOTING AND HELPDESK

DAY3

TASKS:1

List 5 common BIOS or POST error messages you might see when starting a PC and write what hardware or configuration issue each one usually points to.

RESULT

BIOS/POST Error Message	Hardware or Configuration Issue
CMOS Checksum Error – Defaults Loaded	CMOS battery is weak or BIOS settings have been reset.
Keyboard Error or No Keyboard Present	Keyboard is not connected or is faulty.
No Boot Device Found	Hard disk/SSD is not detected or has no operating system installed.
CPU Fan Error	CPU cooling fan is not connected or has failed.
Memory Error / RAM Failure	RAM is loose, faulty, or not detected by the motherboard.

TASKS:2

Given this scenario: On boot, a PC beeps 3 times in a repeating pattern and does not display anything on the screen. Research and write what

this POST beep code typically means for an AMI BIOS, and suggest two troubleshooting steps.

RESULT

For **AMI BIOS**, **3 short beeps** usually indicate a **RAM (Memory) failure**. This means the system cannot properly detect or use the installed memory.

Troubleshooting Steps

Step 1: Reseat the RAM

- Turn off the PC and unplug the power.
- Remove the RAM module.
- Clean the contacts (if needed) and insert it firmly back into the slot.

Step 2: Test the RAM

- Try one RAM stick at a time.
- If available, install a known working RAM module to check whether the original RAM is faulty

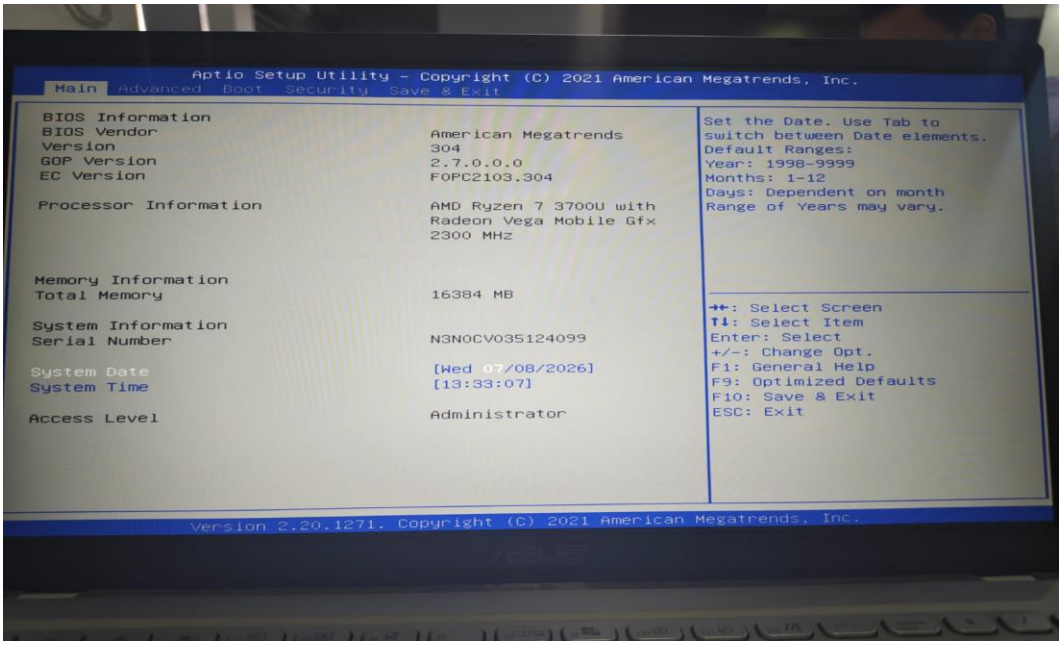
TASKS:3

Access the BIOS setup utility on any available PC or virtual machine, take a screenshot of the main BIOS screen, and identify the motherboard manufacturer and BIOS version.

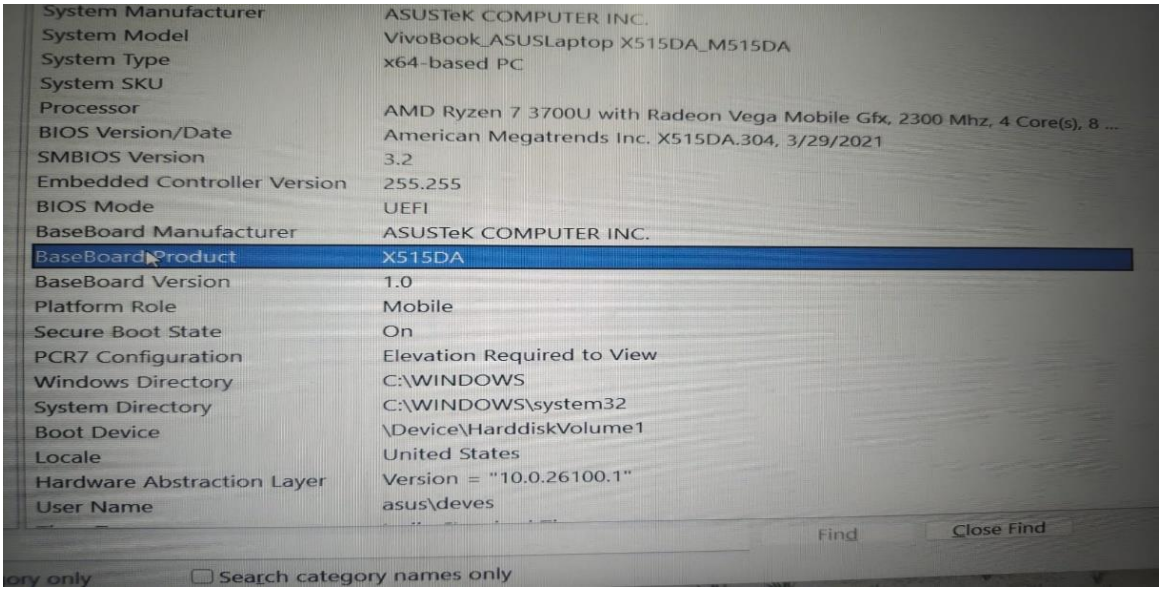
RESULT

BIOS SETUP PAGE:

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MOTHERBOARD MANUFACTURER:



TASKS:4

You are given a screenshot of a POST error message that says 'CMOS checksum error – Defaults loaded.' Explain what this means and

describe how you would resolve this issue in a real system. Think about the CMOS battery and BIOS settings reset.

RESULT

The message **"CMOS Checksum Error – Defaults Loaded"** means that the BIOS settings stored in CMOS memory have become invalid or were reset. This usually happens because the **CMOS battery (CR2032)** is weak or has been removed.

How to Resolve the Issue

1. Turn off the computer.
2. Open the computer case.
3. Locate the **CMOS battery** on the motherboard.
4. Replace the battery with a new **CR2032** battery if necessary.
5. Start the computer and enter the BIOS Setup.
6. Set the correct **date and time**.
7. Save the BIOS settings and restart the computer.